SENATE PROCLAMATION NO. 296

WHEREAS, The Senate of the State of Texas is pleased to recognize Benno Engel, who is being honored as a 2026 Living Legend of New Braunfels by the Braunfels Foundation Trust in recognition of his professional excellence and service to his community; and

WHEREAS, Born and raised in Luckenbach, Benno was the youngest of six children and learned German at home as his first language; he went on to earn a bachelor's degree in education and a master's degree in German from Texas Tech University, laying the foundation for his lifelong connection to education, his German heritage, and the traditions of Central Texas; and

WHEREAS, Benno married his wife, Jan, in 1975; together, they built a life centered on family and helping others, and they have found great joy as the proud parents of their daughter, Ashley; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Engel proudly served in the United States Army Reserve for 27 years, and he utilized his background to create meaningful educational opportunities for students through international travel and cultural experiences; and

WHEREAS, An exemplary educator, Mr. Engel dedicated 40 years to teaching German and social studies at New Braunfels High School and at high schools in Smithson Valley and Canyon Lake; he also served as chair of the foreign language department for 25 years in New Braunfels and was honored as a New Braunfels Independent School District Secondary Teacher of the Year; and

WHEREAS, Benno has been a steadfast advocate of his city's German heritage and community traditions through nearly five decades of working with the Wurstfest Association; he has held

such notable roles with the organization as president, Opa Emeritus, Grosse Opa, and chair of various committees, and he helped to strengthen partnerships between New Braunfels and its sister city, Braunfels, Germany; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Engel has given generously of his time to many local organizations, including Saint Paul Lutheran Church, the Sophienburg Museum and Archives, the Greater New Braunfels Chamber of Commerce, and the Braunfels Foundation Trust; he contributed to the city's 150th anniversary celebration and served as vice chairman of the 175th anniversary committee; and

WHEREAS, In 2021, Benno Engel was recognized for his community involvement with the Greater New Braunfels Chamber of Commerce Hall of Honor award; through his lifelong devotion to civic service, he has helped the City of New Braunfels to flourish, and it is indeed fitting that he receive special recognition for his altruistic and invaluable efforts; now, therefore, be it

PROCLAIMED, That the Senate of the State of Texas hereby congratulate Benno Engel on his selection as a 2026 Living Legend of New Braunfels and extend to him sincere best wishes in all his future endeavors; and, be it further

PROCLAIMED, That a copy of this Proclamation be prepared for him as an expression of esteem from the Texas Senate.

Campbell

_____

Member, Texas Senate

I hereby certify that the above Proclamation was adopted.

_____

Secretary of the Senate